MATTHEW O'LEARY

Print Production Lead | Prepress, Packaging, Publishing & Large-Format

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Print production leader and production artist with 20+ years producing magazines, books, 800+ page catalogs, packaging, and large-format and out-of-home (OOH) campaigns. Currently Designer & Production Manager for *California* magazine, taking each issue through press with Quad. Build templates, file standards, and AI-assisted InDesign automation that keep work press-ready.

CORE SKILLS

- Production management: Scheduling, page flow, approval cycles, quality control, archiving.
- Prepress and premedia: PDF/X preflight, CMYK and Pantone color, separations, imposition, proofing.
- InDesign automation and AI: Templates, GREP styles, Data Merge, ExtendScript, AI-assisted tools.
- Large-format / wide-format and out-of-home (OOH): Billboards, truck and bus wraps, building drapes, event booths and signage, wayfinding.
- Publishing: Magazines, books, covers and spines, retail catalogs, curriculum, accessible PDFs.
- Packaging: Dielines, spot-color separations, flexo, die-cut, multi-SKU mechanicals, FDA labels.
- Printer and vendor management: RFQs, job awards, offset, digital, flexo, screen, press checks.
- Software: Adobe InDesign, Illustrator, Photoshop, Acrobat Pro, Enfocus PitStop, Figma, Jira, Trello, Airtable, Microsoft Office, ChatGPT, Claude.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Designer & Production Manager | *California* Magazine (Cal Alumni Association)
Aug 2026 – Present | Remote, Contract

- Own magazine production from layout through press: page flow, ad preflight, image placement, and final files for editorial, advertising, and inserts.
- Manage the printer relationship with Quad, from file delivery and proof approval to press coordination, on a fixed publication schedule.

Production Consultant & Designer | Matt O'Leary Design
Jan 2010 – Present | Santa Cruz, CA

- Manage production for publishing, packaging, and collateral clients, including FDA-compliant labels and print vendor coordination.
- Create screen-print color separations for clients including O'Neill Surf Shop.

Production Support Specialist | OBXtek
Dec 2024 – Oct 2025 | Defense Language Institute contract | Monterey, CA

- Produced long-form foreign-language curriculum in InDesign for 14+ languages, with QC and accessible PDFs.

Senior Product Designer | Wiser Solutions
Apr 2022 – Mar 2023 | Remote

Senior Product Designer | Axway
Mar 2018 – Apr 2022 | Remote

- Built template-driven systems and standardized branding across global print and digital campaigns; led a team of designers in a player/coach role.

Product Designer | Kiteworks
Aug 2014 – Feb 2018 | Palo Alto, CA

Creative Lead | FastPencil
Oct 2011 – May 2014 | Campbell, CA

- Designed and produced 50+ books: interiors, covers, and full cover spreads with calculated spines, building templates and style hierarchies for each.
- Directed freelance designers and implemented automated production workflows.

Production Manager | McDill Associates
Sep 2008 – Oct 2011 | Soquel, CA

- Managed print production and designed packaging for national brands including Costco, Martinelli's, and Rainbow Light.
- Built dielines, spot-color separations, and regulated copy for multi-SKU packaging.
- Ran three-vendor RFQs, awarded jobs, and ran press checks.
- Produced out-of-home and large-format work, including billboards, truck and bus wraps, building drapes, event booths, and directional signage for trade shows like PMA.

Prepress Manager | West Marine
Jan 2002 – Aug 2008 | Watsonville, CA

- Managed prepress for 800+ page national retail catalogs, including preflight, color management, pagination, imposition, and proofing.
- Adapted catalog creative into billboards, truck wraps, event booths, and store signage, preparing files to each vendor's large-format specs.
- Coordinated print vendors and ran press checks at Midwest printers.

Co-founder | The Juice Surf Magazine
1994 – 2000 | Santa Cruz, CA

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz – Coursework in Art, Design & Visual Studies
San Jose State University – Coursework in Graphic Design